

How HR Policies can Mitigate InnerSource Challenges

InnerSource (IS) is the use of open source software development best practices and the establishment of an open source-like culture inside organisations, especially for the development of proprietary or non-open source software. Let's explore some of the common challenges faced by organisations that are on their IS journey.



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Like open source, IS has its set of benefits and challenges. Some benefits include faster time-to-market, higher code quality, innovative development, wider collaboration, reduced costs, increased reuse, and so on. But as more organisations embrace IS for its benefits, they should look out for the challenges and be prepared to sort them out.

In this article we will see some of the common challenges faced by organisations that are on the way to explore IS. We will also look at how

a company's policies, from a human resources (HR) perspective, can help mitigate these challenges and provide a conducive environment for IS adoption and success.

IS implementation involves a lot of cultural/behavioural changes like developing a collaborative mindset, decentralised decision making, etc. The HR business unit can especially be helpful in driving such changes by hiring the right staff, keeping them motivated for such changes, and creating awareness about the benefits of IS.

InnerSource challenges

Challenges faced by organisations when they adopt InnerSource can be broadly grouped into three categories.

1. **Operational:** Differences between conventional and IS software development practices can lead to challenges in adoption.
2. **Organisational:** Organisational policies and culture, like targets, incentives and code ownership, can create roadblocks if they don't take IS into account.